

Pitch and judging

A working demo on a testnet carries the most weight, so get the minimum working before anything fancy.

github.com/murthyroshan/innoblock-2.0-starter

Judging criteria

Criterion	Marks	What judges look for
Working prototype & codebase	30	The live demo works end to end on a testnet; transactions are visible on the explorer; no hard-coded fakes; the code in the repo is what runs, and it's readable with error handling
Blockchain	25	The chain is needed, not decorative; a sensible on-chain / off-chain split; the contract is verified on the explorer
Technical quality (GitHub, README, smart contract)	15	A clean public repo with no secrets in its history; a complete README (setup, how to test, contract and live links); a readable, commented smart contract
Pitch and Q&A	15	How well you understood the problem statement you were given and explain your solution to it, on time; every member can answer questions about their own part
Innovation	10	A fresh angle; AI or other integrations that add real value
UI / UX	5	Easy to follow; clear transaction status and feedback
Total	100	

Pitch structure (3 minutes)

Plan for 3 minutes plus questions; the exact slot length is confirmed on Day 1.

Time	Say / show
0:00 – 0:20	Hook. Your problem statement in one sentence, with a real example of who it hurts
0:20 – 0:50	Solution. What you built, and why it needs a blockchain
0:50 – 2:20	Live demo. One happy path, ending on the explorer page
2:20 – 2:45	How it works. One architecture slide
2:45 – 3:00	What's next, and the team

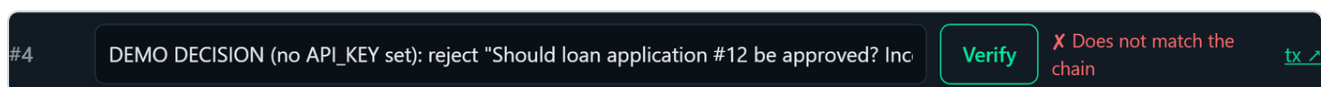
Slides: five or six, no more

1. **Title:** project name, team, domain, contract address

2. **Problem**
3. **Solution**
4. **Architecture** (the diagram in 02 · Build is a good base)
5. **Demo**, or a QR code to the live app
6. **What's next**

Demo tips

- Start with the wallet **already connected and funded** and the backend already awake.
- Zoom the browser to 125–150% so the back row can read it.
- Keep demo inputs in a notes file and paste them; don't type live.
- Show the **explorer page** for a transaction: it's the proof that it's real.
- The tamper test makes a strong moment: change one character, press Verify, watch it fail.



- If the live demo breaks, switch to the backup video within 15 seconds. Skip the long apology.

Questions to prepare for

- Why a blockchain and not just a database?
- What exactly is on-chain, and what isn't? Why?
- What does one transaction cost, and who pays for it?
- What happens if your backend goes down?
- How do you stop someone writing fake data to your contract?
- What would change to run this on mainnet?
- Who is your user, and why would they switch to this?

Demo day checklist

- ☐ Frontend deployed and accessible: open it on a phone, on mobile data
- ☐ Backend awake: ping `/health` just before you present
- ☐ Database connected: a record created this morning still loads
- ☐ Environment variables set on Render and Vercel, not only on your laptop
- ☐ HTTPS on every URL (automatic on these platforms)
- ☐ Full flow tested **30 minutes** before your slot
- ☐ Local backup running: backend on `localhost:5000`, frontend on `localhost:8000`, with `BACKEND_URL` ready to switch
- ☐ Demo wallet **and** backend wallet each hold test tokens
- ☐ Only one wallet extension enabled
- ☐ Tabs open: the app, the contract on the explorer, a past successful transaction, the slides

- ☐ Backup demo video (1–2 minutes) saved **offline** on the laptop
 - ☐ Phone hotspot ready in case the Wi-Fi drops
 - ☐ Laptop charged; charger and HDMI / USB-C adapter in hand
 - ☐ Notifications off; browser zoomed in
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Submission checklist

- ☐ Public GitHub repo, with no `.env` anywhere in its history
- ☐ README: overview, why blockchain, architecture, setup, env variable table, how to test on the testnet, team
- ☐ Contract address with a link to its **verified** explorer page
- ☐ Live frontend URL and backend URL
- ☐ Demo video link
- ☐ Slides as PDF
- ☐ Team name, members and domain

Where and when to submit is announced on Day 1.